Important linux commond

🔵 1. Navigation (move around fast)

- pwd → show current directory
- ls → list files
- ls -la → show hidden files + permissions
- cd folder → enter folder
- cd .. → go back
- cd ~ → go to home

👉 **Use in pentesting:** quickly explore system directories after gaining access

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🔵 2. File & Folder Management

- mkdir test → create folder
- rm file.txt → delete file
- rm -rf folder → delete folder (force) ⚠️
- cp file1 file2 → copy file
- mv file newname → rename
- mv file /path/ → move

👉 **Use:** manage payloads, wordlists, scripts

🔵 3. File Viewing & Editing

- cat file.txt → view file
- less file.txt → scroll file
- head file.txt → first lines
- tail file.txt → last lines
- tail -f log.txt → live logs
- nano file.txt → edit file

👉 **Use:** read configs, logs, credentials

🟢 4. Search (VERY IMPORTANT)

- find / -name file.txt → find file
- grep "text" file.txt → search inside file
- grep -r "password" /home → search recursively

👉 **Use:** find passwords, keys, sensitive data

🟢 5. Permissions & Ownership

- ls -l → check permissions
- chmod +x file.sh → make executable
- chmod 777 file → full access (dangerous)
- chown user file → change owner

👉 **Use:** privilege escalation, running scripts

🟢 6. Users & Privileges

- whoami → current user
- id → user details
- sudo command → run as admin
- passwd → change password

👉 **Use:** check access level during attack

🟢 7. Processes (system control)

- ps aux → list processes
- top → live processes
- kill PID → stop process
- kill -9 PID → force kill

👉 **Use:** find suspicious processes / exploit running services

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🟢 8. Networking (VERY IMPORTANT)

- ip a → show IP
- ifconfig → network info

- ping target → test connectivity
- netstat -tuln → open ports
- ss -tuln → modern port check

👉 **Use:** identify target system & services

🔵 9. Package Management (install tools)

- sudo apt update → update repo
- sudo apt upgrade → upgrade system
- sudo apt install nmap → install tool

👉 **Use:** install pentesting tools

🔵 10. Archives & Files

- zip file.zip file.txt
- unzip file.zip
- tar -cvf file.tar folder/
- tar -xvf file.tar

👉 **Use:** transfer payloads, compress data

🔵 11. Download & Transfer

- wget http://file → download
- curl http://site → fetch data

👉 **Use:** download exploits, tools

🔵 12. Disk & System Info

- df -h → disk usage
- du -sh folder → folder size
- uname -a → system info
- hostname → system name

👉 **Use:** understand target system

🔘 13. History & Shortcuts

- history → command history
- clear → clear screen
- Ctrl + C → stop command
- Tab → auto-complete

👉 **Use:** speed + efficiency